

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Mayor's budget moving forward

\$17.3B 2025 spending plan narrowly passes through 2 committees

By A.D. Quig and Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

The key planks of Mayor Brandon Johnson's budget proposal barely made it through two City Council committees Tuesday, setting up a tight finish for his administration as it tries to pass the \$17.3 billion 2025 spending plan.

The Finance Committee narrowly approved his proposed \$68.5 million property tax hike and a slew of other tax and fee hikes ahead of an expected full budget vote later this week. The final vote on the revenue package was 14-12.

Later, the Budget Committee approved the mayor's management ordinance — which lays out how money will be spent — by just one vote.

It passed 17-16, only after Ald. Lamont Robinson, 4th, returned from outside council chambers to log his "yes" vote, and after the committee recessed for several minutes to make last-minute tweaks.

Aldermen who voted no in the committees offered few comments about their remaining objections to the package after months of tense negotiations, but the close votes show Johnson has little margin as he tries to get his plan through the full council as soon as Friday. The council and the mayor face an end-of-year deadline to pass the city's 2025 spending plan or risk an unprecedented budget crisis that could shut down government services and harm the city's financial standing.

A total of 18 out of 50 aldermen voted against some part of Johnson's plan Tuesday, though not all City Council members sit on the Finance and Budget committees.

Among the no votes in the Finance Committee were Alder-

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Luigi Mangione is led into the Blair County Courthouse for an extradition hearing Tuesday in Hollidaysburg, Pennsylvania. Mangione has been arraigned on weapons and false identification charges related to the shooting of United Healthcare CEO Brian Thompson. **JEFF SWENSEN/GETTY**

Suspect in killing of CEO will fight extradition to NY

Police say alleged gunman noted anger at health insurers

By Michael R. Sisak and Mark Scalforo

Associated Press

ALTOONA, Pa. — The suspect in the killing of UnitedHealthcare's CEO struggled with deputies and shouted Tuesday while arriving for a court appearance in Pennsylvania, a day after he was arrested at a McDonald's and charged with murder.

Luigi Nicholas Mangione emerged from a patrol car, spun toward reporters and shouted something partly unintelligible referring to an "insult to the intelligence of the American

people" while deputies pushed him inside.

Prosecutors were beginning to take steps to bring Mangione back to New York to face a murder charge while new details emerged about his life and how he was captured. The 26-year-old Ivy League graduate from a prominent Maryland real estate family was charged with murder hours after he was arrested in the Manhattan killing of Brian Thompson, who led the United States' largest medical insurance company.

At the brief hearing, defense lawyer Thomas Dickey informed

the court that Mangione will not waive extradition to New York but instead wants a hearing on the issue. Mangione was denied bail after prosecutors raised concerns about public safety and a potential flight risk.

Mangione, wearing an orange prison jumpsuit, mostly stared straight ahead at the hearing, occasionally consulting papers, rocking in his chair or looking back at the gallery. At one point, he began to speak to respond to the court discussion but was quieted by his lawyer.

Mangione likely was motivated by his anger with what he

called "parasitic" health insurance companies and a disdain for corporate greed, a law enforcement bulletin obtained by The Associated Press said.

He wrote that the U.S. has the most expensive health care system in the world and that profits of major corporations continue to rise while "our life expectancy" does not, according to the bulletin, based on a review of his handwritten notes and social media posts.

Mangione called "Unabomber" Ted Kaczynski a "political revolutionary" and may have found inspiration from the man who carried out a series

Turn to Suspect, Page 2



Angelica Glogowski, a UIC student, left, administers an mpox vaccine to Iselle Jimenez, center, while Minseung Chu, clinical assistant professor at UIC College of Nursing converses with the pair at a vaccine event at Calor, a Latino nonprofit catering to people with HIV, in Humboldt Park on Oct. 30. **TESS CROWLEY/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Another strain of mpox has arrived in the US. How is Chicago preparing?

By Jade-Ruyu Yan

Weekly cases of mpox, the virus formerly known as monkeypox, have remained in the single digits in Chicago this year. That's much lower than during the virus's outbreak two years ago, which at its peak saw cases reach over 140 in a week, but "it's concerning that it's still circulating" in the U.S., said Dr. Aniruddha Hazra, associate professor of medicine and director of the Infectious Diseases Fellowship Program at the University of Chicago.

And now, the U.S. has seen its first case of another more virulent strain of the virus, known as clade I. This clade first began to spread in the Congo and has killed over 600 people, according to numbers in a September study. Cases have since been reported in other countries such as the Philippines, Sweden and Thailand.

The U.S.' first case was recorded in California mid-November, with the patient reportedly experiencing mild symptoms.

Funding and resources for fighting mpox — which causes a

blister-like rash and, in the worst cases, death — have declined in the U.S. But in Chicago, efforts to vaccinate vulnerable populations and educate them about mpox have remained in place.

During the first outbreak, the virus disproportionately impacted gay and bisexual men and other men who have sex with men. In this newer outbreak, researchers studying mpox transmission in a province of the Congo noted this summer that

Turn to Mpox, Page 4

Illinois environment and labor leaders look to align

Delegation flew to Germany for insights on transit, highways

By John Lippert
Chicago Tribune

Jennifer Walling runs an organization that speaks for over 100 environmental groups in Springfield. Marc Poulos is a political quarterback for organized labor.

Both say they could do more to protect Illinois' environment if they took fewer potshots at each other.

Last weekend, they flew to Germany as part of a civic delegation looking for clues on fixing Chicago's battered mass transit system. They're also seeking common ground on crumbling highways, leaky natural gas pipe-

lines and smoky tailpipes.

"I feel like we both understand that we're going to get more done if we're aligned," said Walling, executive director of the Illinois Environmental Council. "We may as well be on the same page instead of fighting each other and wasting resources."

She said the state needs such a rapprochement in part because President-elect Donald Trump may be less likely than his predecessor to help deep-blue Illinois.

Tom Kotarac, senior vice president of the Commercial Club of Chicago's civic committee, said everybody on the trip, including a bipartisan group of lawmakers, all paid their own way. Kotarac said he worked with Deutsche Bahn AG, Germany's national

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INSIDE



Cubs outfielder Seiya Suzuki. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/TRIBUNE**

Cubs evaluate the trade market

Seiya Suzuki would consider waiving his no-trade clause if the Cubs want to move the outfielder. **Chicago Sports**

Restaurant scene adds another star

Michelin announces 2024 awards and Chicago has a new one-star restaurant in its repertoire: Uptown's Cariño. **Food & Health**

